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Postgraduate Admission & Student Portal

Introductory Hands-On User Guide

Welcome to the **Postgraduate Admission & Student Portal**.

This short guide provides a practical introduction to the system and walks you through the main admission process, from submitting an application to accepting an offer and receiving your student account.

Access the System

Portal: [Insert system URL here]

Video walkthrough: Google Drive walkthrough video

> **Tip:** Watch the walkthrough video while following the steps in this guide. The video demonstrates the process using a sample application.

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1. Understanding the Registration Process

In this system, **Registration means applying for admission** rather than simply creating a user account.

There is **no self-service account creation** for applicants.

A portal account is automatically created when an applicant has been admitted, accepts the offer, and proceeds to enrolment.

The admission process follows these main steps:

Apply → Application Review → Admission Decision → Offer → Accept Offer → Student Account Creation

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2. Step 1 — Visit the Landing Page

Open the system using the portal URL provided above.

The landing page provides:

- Information about the postgraduate programmes
- A guide explaining how to apply
- The **Apply** option
- The **Sign In** option

If you are a new applicant, select **Apply** to begin the admission application.

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3. Step 2 — Complete the Admission Application

The **Apply** page contains the university's admission application form **ADM-AF/01A**.

You will be required to provide information such as:

- Personal details
- Contact information
- Academic background
- Programme applied for
- Study mode
- Details of two academic referees

Complete all required sections carefully before submitting the application.

Important

Ensure that the information provided is accurate. The information submitted through the application will be used during the admission review process.

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4. Step 3 — Receive Your Application Reference

After submitting the application, the system provides an **application reference number**.

You will also receive a private tracking link.

The tracking link allows you to monitor the progress of your application without creating a portal account.

Use the link in the following format:

`/track/{token}`

Keep your application reference and tracking link safe.

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5. Step 4 — Application Review

Once an application has been submitted, it moves into the university's admission review workflow.

The typical process is:

Applicant → HOD Recommendation → Director, BPS Decision → Offer

HOD Review

The Head of Department reviews the application and makes a recommendation.

Director, BPS

The Director, BPS makes the admission decision based on the review.

Reviewers access applications through the **Admissions** section of the portal.

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6. Step 5 — Receive and Accept the Offer

If the applicant is successful, the system sends an admission offer.

The applicant can then log into the portal and **accept the offer online**.

After the offer is accepted, the system automatically:

1. Creates the student's portal account.
2. Generates an admission number.

3. Creates the student's student profile.
4. Sends the account credentials to the student by email.

The student can then use the credentials to access the student portal.

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7. User Roles

The system supports the following main user roles:

Role	Main Function
Admin	System administration and user management
Student	Application, admission, academic and student activities
Supervisor	Student supervision and progress monitoring
HOD	Departmental application review and recommendations
Dean	Faculty-level oversight and review
Director, BPS	Admission decision and postgraduate oversight
Finance	Financial and payment-related activities
Registrar	Registry and student administration
Ethics Reviewer	Ethical review of research activities
Committee	Committee-level review and decisions

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8. Demo Accounts

For demonstration and training purposes, the following accounts are available.

Role	Email	Password
Admin	`admin@postgrad.ac.ke`	`admin123`
Supervisor	`supervisor@postgrad.ac.ke`	`supervisor123`
Student	`student@postgrad.ac.ke`	`student123`
HOD	`hod@postgrad.ac.ke`	`hod123`
Dean	`dean@postgrad.ac.ke`	`dean123`
Director (BPS)	`director@postgrad.ac.ke`	`director123`
Ethics Reviewer	`ethics@postgrad.ac.ke`	`ethics123`

Recommended Hands-On Exercise

For a quick demonstration of the admission workflow:

1. Open the portal landing page.
2. Select **Apply**.
3. Complete the admission form using the demonstration applicant details.
4. Submit the application.
5. Record the application reference number.
6. Log in as **HOD** using the demo HOD account.
7. Open **Admissions**.
8. Locate the submitted application.
9. Review and recommend the applicant.
10. Log in as **Director (BPS)**.
11. Review the recommended application.
12. Make the admission decision.
13. Return to the applicant workflow and accept the offer.
14. Verify that the student account and admission number are created.

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9. Email Notifications

The system sends email notifications at important stages of the admission process.

During development and demonstration, emails use:

`MAIL_MAILER=log`

This means that emails are **not actually delivered to the recipient's mailbox**. Instead, the generated email content is recorded in:

`storage/logs/laravel.log`

For production deployment, the system should be configured with an SMTP mail service so that admission and account notifications are delivered to users.

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10. Suggested 10-Minute Walkthrough

For a short training session, demonstrate the system in this order:

1. Landing Page
Show the programme information and **Apply / Sign In** options.

2. Application
Open the ADM-AF/01A form and demonstrate the main sections.

3. Submission
Submit the application and show the generated reference number and tracking link.

4. HOD Review
Log in as HOD and demonstrate how an application is reviewed and recommended.

5. Director Decision
Log in as Director, BPS, and demonstrate the admission decision.

6. Applicant Acceptance
Return to the applicant workflow and demonstrate offer acceptance.

7. Student Account
Show how the system automatically creates the student account

and admission number.

8. Student Login
Log in using the newly created student credentials and demonstrate the student dashboard.

Quick Reference

Applicant

Apply → Submit → Track Application → Receive Offer → Accept Offer → Receive Student Credentials

HOD

Sign In → Admissions → Review Application → Recommend

Director, BPS

Sign In → Admissions → Review Recommendation → Make Decision

Student

Sign In → Student Dashboard → Access Postgraduate Services

Training Resources

System: Open the Postgraduate Admission & Student Portal

Video: Watch the Google Drive Hands-On Walkthrough

> **Note:** Replace the two placeholder links above with the actual production/test portal URL and Google Drive video link before distributing this guide.